

India , That is Bharat

1. India and the Indian Subcontinent

- India is an ancient land with a long history.
 - The region is often called the Indian Subcontinent.
 - Its boundaries and names changed over time.
 - Natural boundaries:
 - Himalayas in the north
 - Indian Ocean in the south
 - Arabian Sea in the west
 - Bay of Bengal in the east
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2. Ancient Names Given by Indians

Sapta Sindhava

- Mentioned in the Ṛig Veda.
- Means "Land of Seven Rivers".
- Refers mainly to northwestern India.
- Derived from the word Sindhu (Indus River).

Bhāratavarṣha

- Mentioned in the Mahābhārata.
- Means "Land of the Bharatas".
- Refers to the entire Indian Subcontinent.
- Later became the most common name for India.

Jambudvīpa

- Means "Island of the Jamun Tree".
 - Another ancient name for the Indian Subcontinent.
 - Used by Emperor Ashoka in his inscriptions.
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3. Regions Mentioned in Ancient Texts

The Mahābhārata mentions many regions:

- Kāshmīra (Kashmir)
- Kurukṣhetra (Haryana)
- Vanga (Bengal)
- Prāgjyotiṣha (Assam)
- Kaccha (Kutch)
- Kerala

This shows that ancient Indians were aware of the geography of the whole Subcontinent.

4. Bhārata in Ancient Literature

Viṣṇu Purāṇa Definition

"The country north of the ocean and south of the snowy mountains is called Bhārata."

- Snowy mountains = Himalayas
- Ocean = Indian Ocean

Tamil Literature

- Ancient Tamil poems also describe India as stretching:
 - From Cape Kumari (Kanyakumari) in the south
 - To the Himalayas in the north.
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5. India in the Constitution

- The Constitution begins with:

"India, that is Bharat"
 - Both names are officially recognized.
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6. Names Given by Foreigners

Persian Name

- Persians called the region:

- Hind
- Hidu
- Hindu
- Derived from Sindhu.

Greek Name

- Greeks called India:
 - Indoi
 - Indike
- Derived from Persian "Hindu".

Chinese Names

- Yintu / Yindu
- Tianzhu
- Derived from Sindhu and associated with Buddhism.

Hindustan

- First appeared in a Persian inscription about 1,800 years ago.
- Later widely used by travellers and rulers.

Modern Name

- Latin and English: India
- French: Inde

7. Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang)

- Chinese scholar and traveller.
- Visited India in the 7th century CE.
- Stayed for 17 years.
- Collected Buddhist texts and translated them into Chinese.

Flow of India's Names

Sindhu → Hindu → Indoi/Indike → India

Sindhu → Hindu → Yindu (China)

